

ROD PARSLEY MWANGI

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PROFILE

With dual degrees in International Relations and Anthropology from Riara University and the University of Nairobi, I've spent the past two years working across government, UN agencies, and civil society on policy research, programme coordination, and M&E systems design. This work has ranged from contributing to Kenya's Beijing+30 Country Report and drafting technical submissions for CSW69, to leading field research generating evidence for gender-responsive programming. Through it, I've come to see inclusion not merely as a moral position but as a systems requirement for sustainable outcomes. It's a conviction that shapes how I show up: curious, thorough, and ready to do the work that makes systems actually work for people.

KEY COMPETENCIES

Research & Evidence • Qualitative & Quantitative Research • M&E Framework Design & Tracking • Data Collection & Analysis (Kobo, NVivo) • Mixed-Methods Research Design	Policy & Documentation • Policy Research & Legislative Analysis • Report Writing & Strategic Communication • Briefs, Talking Points & Concept Notes • Human Rights Monitoring (CEDAW, UPR)	Programme & Governance • Multi-Stakeholder Coordination • Gender Mainstreaming & GBA+ • SEAH/Ethics Compliance Frameworks • Grant Management & Donor Reporting
Facilitation & Engagement • Workshop Facilitation & Dialogue • Training & Capacity Strengthening • Youth & Civic Empowerment	Tools & Software • Kobo Toolbox, NVivo, Power BI, Excel • MS Office, Google Workspace • Canva, Trello, SurveyMonkey	Languages • English (Native) • Swahili (Native) • French (Basic – A1)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Manager

Parsley's Farm

August 2025 – Present | Kajiado County, Kenya

- Established and managing a 2.6-acre commercial vegetable operation under drip irrigation in semi-arid conditions; overseeing crop protection, irrigation scheduling, labour coordination, and market access for a two-worker team
- Harvested 8.7 tonnes of onions from 1.4 acres in first production season; featured on Citizen TV's Kenya's Gold programme

Research Assistant

UPDATE Research Project – Institute of Anthropology, Gender and African Studies, University of Nairobi

January 2026 – March 2026 | Nairobi, Kenya

- Collected quantitative and qualitative data on how digital technologies shape access to work, income, and collective organization, administering research instruments in accordance with ethical protocols
- Maintained field records, contributed to qualitative transcription, and participated in enumerator training and feedback sessions

Research & Technical Support (Consultancy)

Lonah Mueni Wanjama, Senior Gender & Development Consultant – UNIDO-Commissioned Assignment

December 2025 – Present | Nairobi, Kenya

- Providing research and analytical support for a UNIDO-commissioned gender analysis of the Energy Efficiency for Sustainable Livelihoods in Africa (EELA) Kenya Country Window, a Sida-funded programme
- Conducting literature review and evidence synthesis across four project outcomes, sourcing data from IRENA, ENERGIA, Clean Cooking Alliance, and Kenya's national energy and gender policy frameworks
- Synthesizing tea-energy nexus evidence linking gendered labour dynamics in Kenya's tea sector (650,000+ KTDA smallholder farmers) to industrial energy consumption and deforestation

Field Coordinator & M&E Lead (Consultancy)

UN Women Kenya – Gender-Based Analysis Plus (GBA+) for Blue & Circular Economies

November 2025 – December 2025 | Kwale & Lamu Counties, Kenya

- Designed M&E framework and developed data collection tools using Kobo Toolbox for mixed-methods GBA+ assessment examining gender dimensions of financial inclusion, ecosystem governance, and green jobs
- Led field coordination for data collection with 175+ respondents across two counties, conducting KIIs and FGDs with women, youth, fishing communities, and LNOB groups

- Recruited, trained, and managed field enumerators, ensuring data quality, ethical research practices, and adherence to UN Women safeguarding protocols
- Conducted desk review synthesizing GBA+ studies from Plan International, MEDA, World Bank, and other development partners to inform primary research design

Program Assistant (Consultancy)

Tarucca East Africa Ltd (Accurat) – Union-to-Union Global Pilot on Ethical Governance
January 2025 – September 2025 | Nairobi, Kenya

- Supported 18 Kenyan trade unions to develop and institutionalize Codes of Conduct, SEAH, and Anti-Corruption policies aligned with Kenya’s Constitution (2010), Sexual Offences Act (2006), Employment Act (2007), and ILO conventions
- Synthesized legal research into model policy clauses ensuring enforceability, survivor-centered safeguards, and organizational alignment with international labor standards
- Produced validation reports, learning briefs, and workshop documentation; developed IEC materials and led donor reporting, capturing implementation challenges and success stories for regional replication across Sub-Saharan Africa

Policy Intern – Gender Policy Research & Documentation

State Department for Gender and Affirmative Action, Kenya
January 2024 – March 2025 | Nairobi, Kenya

- Contributed to Kenya’s Beijing Platform for Action +30 Country Report featured in regional and global review processes, conducting policy research, drafting core sections, and co-developing a documentary on 30 years of gender reform
- Drafted official speeches, concept notes, high-level briefs, policy summaries, and talking points for the Principal Secretary for government events, donor meetings, and international forums
- Served as Convenor for the Technical Paper on Youth and Gender Dialogue for CSW69, incorporating feedback from community-based and youth-led organizations into a unified policy submission
- Provided technical drafting support for the Gender Bill, National Affirmative Action Policy, and Education Sector Gender Policy Review, ensuring alignment with the Constitution (2010), CEDAW, and Maputo Protocol
- Coordinated multi-stakeholder workshops with ministries, UN agencies, CSOs, and development partners; facilitated bilateral engagement under the Kenya–Colombia MOU on GBV; served as rapporteur for interagency forums
- Represented the State Department at a civil society roundtable convened following the Presidential Taskforce on Femicide and GBV, contributing policy advisory inputs to a multi-stakeholder memorandum

EDUCATION

MA in International Studies (Admitted, Fall 2026)
University of Wyoming | School of Politics, Public Affairs, and International Studies

BA in International Relations and Diplomacy | Second Class Upper Division
Riara University, Nairobi, Kenya | 2020 – 2024

BA in Anthropology | Second Class Upper Division
University of Nairobi, Kenya | 2017 – 2022

Diploma in International Studies | Distinction
University of Nairobi, Kenya | 2017 – 2018

Certifications: Gender Equality & Women’s Empowerment (Commonwealth of Learning, 2025) | French A1 (Alliance Française)

STUDENT LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTARY ENGAGEMENT

Riara University (2022–2024): Chaired the university Electoral Commission, restructuring the electoral system by introducing a third-party digital voting platform and developing a comprehensive SOP manual that increased voter turnout and restored trust in democratic processes post-COVID. Co-founded and coordinated the Debate Society, receiving the Best Speaker Award at the Nairobi Klevé Model African Union (2023).

Gospel Outreach Church (2017–Present): Volunteer supporting audiovisual production, digital engagement, and community outreach initiatives.

REFERENCES

Joseph Mutuku Program Associate, UN Women Kenya joseph.peter@unwomen.org +254 727 345 844	Katherine Mbugua General Manager, Accurat katherine@accurat.no +254 722 239 298	Anne Wang’ombe Principal Secretary, State Dept. for Gender awang’ombeboard@gmail.com +254 723 706 540
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